

RENANCE

OSUN STATE UNIVERSITY, OSOGBO

GNS 101 — Past Questions & Materials

by Renance

Course: GNS 101

Institution: Osun State University, Osogbo

Papers in this pack: 1

Levels: 100

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Paper 1 of 1 — GNS 101-Use of English

Level 100 • First Semester • Handout

OSUN STATE UNIVERSITY, OSOGBO,
DEPARTMENT OF ENGLISH & LITERARY
STUDIES

COURSE PROFILE

1. Course Code: GNS 101
2. Course Title: Use of English I
3. Number of Units: 2
4. Course Status: Compulsory
5. Prerequisite(s): Nil
6. Course Objectives: To remedy whatever mechanical and structural weaknesses that may still persist in the students' oral or written use of English and to assist them to develop their perceptive and productive skills to enhance their academic and post-graduation performance.
7. Course Description: This course is both remedial and developmental. The modules on grammar address the language needs of the students while the other modules address their other speaking and reading needs in the form of speaking and speech delivery skills, reading efficiency and comprehension, reading of a literary text as well as a concise introduction to literary interpretation. The listening and writing skills are addressed in GNS 102, the second part of the Use of English course in the form of note taking, outlining, summarization and the different forms of writing.
8. Course Outline:
(Week 1)
 1. PART I: GRAMMAR
 1. Module 1: A study of the parts of speech, grammatical forms and functions
 - A. PARTS OF SPEECH
 1. Nouns and nominal groups-
 - (a) Definitions & Types: common/proper, abstract/concrete, collective etc.
 - (b) Number: singular/plural, count/non-count.
 - (c) Plural formation rules.
 - (d) Typical noun endings: ium/-ia, -ae, -i, -is etc
 - (e) Functions of nouns/nominal groups.
 2. Pronouns
 - (a) Definition/Properties

(b) Types: Personal, Indefinite (or General), Possessive, Demonstrative, Interrogative, Relative, Reflexive, Emphatic (Intensive) Numerical, Reciprocal,

(c) Functions of pronouns

(Week 2)

3. Adjectives

(a) Definition

(b) Properties – endings, comparison (regular/irregular)

(c) Types:

(i) Functional types: descriptive/limiting

(ii) Positional types: attributive, appositive, predicative, post-modifiers

(iii) Compound adjectives

4. Verbs

(a) Definition

(b) Types:

(i) lexical/auxiliary

(ii) transitive/intransitive

(iii) finite/non-finite

(iv) regular/irregular

(c) Properties

(i) inflection

(ii) person

(iii) number

(iv) voice

(v) aspect

(vi) mood

(vii) tense

(viii) verbals

(Week 3)

5. Adverbs

(a) Definition

(b) Properties – mobility, inflection, degrees, comparison

(c) Types:

(i) Adjuncts – manner, time, reason, place, purpose,

concession, degree, frequency, direction

(ii) Conjuncts

(iii) Disjuncts

6. Prepositions

- 7. Conjunctions
- 8. Articles
- 9. Interjections

(Week 4)

B. Morphemes and Words

- 1. Simple and complex words
- 2. Affixation – prefixation and suffixation
- 3. Compound words
- 4. Other word – formation processes – conversion, clipping
acronymy, blending etc
- 5. Spelling – British American, other loan words.

C. Phrases and Clauses

- 1. Definition
- 2. Types
- 3. Functions

(Week 5)

D. Sentences

- 1. Definition
- 2. Types:
 - (a) Formal/structural types: simple, complex,
compound
 - (b) Functional Types: Statements, requests,
commands,
questions, exclamations
- 3. Qualities: unity, coherence, emphasis.
- 4. Sentence structure/elements
 - (a) nominal group
 - (b) verbal group
 - (c) adverbial group
 - (d) prepositional group

E. Exercise and Tutor-marked Assignment

(Week 6)

2. SOME COMMON GRAMMATICAL ERRORS IN NIGERIAN ENGLISH

- (a) Sentence deficiencies to avoid are: unclear (ambiguous, remote
or broad) pronoun reference, faulty predication, comma splices,
fused sentences, faulty parallelism, dangling and misplaced
modifiers, squinting constructions, shifts in person or reference
tense, number, voice and mood.
- (b) Concord errors
- (c) Exercises and tutor-marked assignment

(Week 7)

3. SPEAKING SKILLS

(a) Sounds of English

(i) vowels

(ii) consonants

(iii) problematic sounds not present in students' native languages

(iv) drills with the use of minimal pairs in isolation and in context

(v) strong and weak forms

(Week 8)

(b) Stress

(i) word stress in bi-syllabic and poly-syllabic words

(ii) correction of pronunciation of words with peculiar Nigerian stress pattern

(iii) sentence stress – emphatic and contrastive stress

(c) Rhythm

(d) Intonation

(i) meaning of intonation

(ii) basic intonation patterns in English – falling, rising etc.

(iii) functions – grammatical, attitudinal, accentual etc.

(e) Listening to model English speech and students' speaking practice.

(Week 9)

4A. IMPROVING READING EFFICIENCY

(a) Reading defined

(b) Reading deficiencies to avoid – pointing, vocalization, sub-vocalization, head movement, regression etc.

(c) Techniques for improving reading deficiencies

(i) increasing eye span

(ii) improving eye movement

(iii) improving recognition of thought units

(d) Types of reading

(Week 10)

4B. Improving Reading Comprehension

(i) Identifying main ideas

(ii) Identifying relative importance of details/supporting details

(iii) Skimming – reading for main ideas

(iv) Scanning – reading for specific details

(v) Strategies for study reading – SQ3R method

(Week 11)

4C. Reading of a Literary Text in each of the following genres

(Per Semester)

(i) Prose

(ii) Drama

(iii) Poetry (selected poems)

(Week 12)

5. INTRODUCTION TO LITERARY APPRECIATION

(Weeks 13-14)

6. Revision and Examination

7. Recommended Texts

1.

2.

3.

8. Evaluation: Course work: 30%, Final exam: 70%;

9. Necessary Equipment/Aids:

10. Attendance Policy: Attendance at all classes is mandatory.

11. Date of Revision: October, 2016.

12. Name of Lecturer: All Use of English I & II Lecturers.